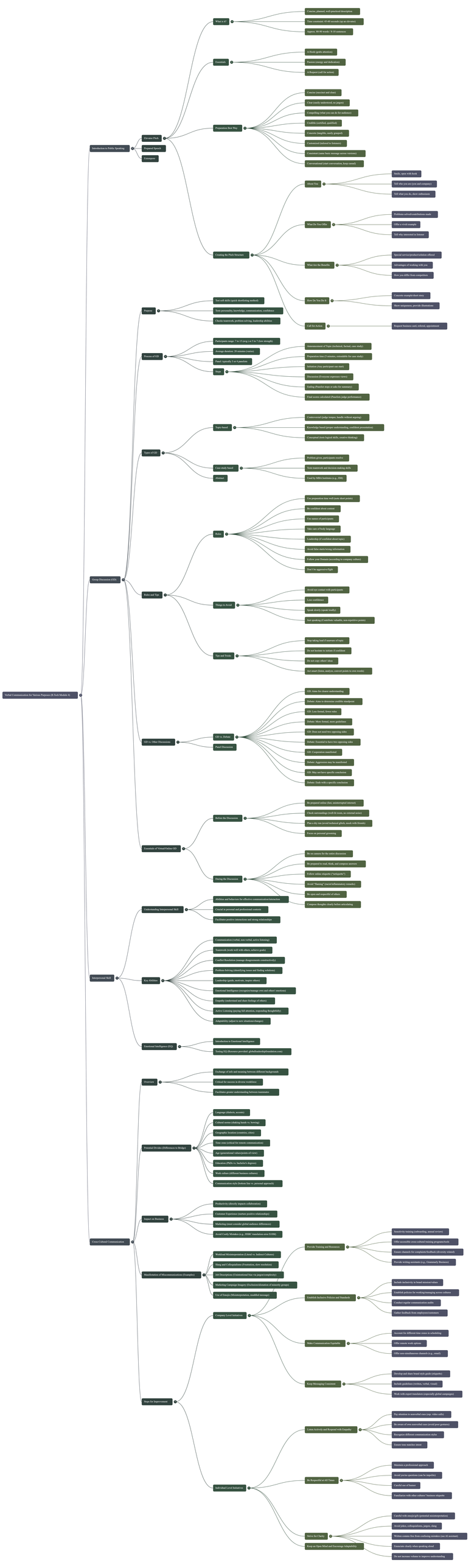
Verbal Communication for Various Purposes (8.Tech Module 4)
Introduction to Public Speaking
Elevator Pitch
What is it?
Concise, planned, well-practiced description
Time constraint: 45-60 seconds (up an elevator)
Approx. 80-90 words / 8-10 sentences
Essentials
A Hook (grabs attention)
Passion (energy and dedication)
A Request (call for action)
Preparation Best Way
Concise (succinct and clear)
Clear (easily understood, no jargon)
Compelling (what you can do for audience)
Credible (certified, qualified)
Concrete (tangible, easily grasped)
Customized (tailored to listeners)
Consistent (same basic message across versions)
Conversational (start conversation, keep casual)
Creating the Pitch Structure
About You
Smile, open with hook
Tell who you are (you and company)
Tell what you do, show enthusiasm
What Do You Offer
Problems solved/contributions made
Offer a vivid example
Tell why interested in listener
What Are the Benefits
Special service/product/solution offered
Advantages of working with you
How you differ from competitors
How Do You Do It
Concrete example/short story
Show uniqueness, provide illustrations
Call for Action
Request business card, referral, appointment
Proposed Speech
Extempore
Group Discussion (GD)
Purpose
Test soft skills (quick shortlisting method)
Tests personality, knowledge, communication, confidence
Checks teamwork, problem-solving, leadership abilities
Process of GD
Participants range: 7 to 15 (avg.) or 5 to 7 (low strength)
Average duration: 20 minutes (varies)
Panel: typically 3 or 4 panelists
Steps
Assessment of Topic (technical, factual, case study)
Preparation time (5 minutes, extendable for case study)
Initiation (Any participant can start)
Discussion (Everyone expresses views)
Ending (Panelist stops or asks for summary)
Final scores calculated (Panelists judge performance)
Types of GD
Topic-based
Controversial (judge tempers, handle without arguing)
Knowledge based (proper understanding, confident presentation)
Conceptual (tests logical skills, creative thinking)
Case-study based
Problem given, participants resolve
Tests teamwork and decision-making skills
Used by MBA Institutes (e.g., ISB)
Abstract
Rules and Tips
Rules
Use preparation time well (note short points)
Be confident about content
Use names of participants
Take care of body language
Leadership (if confident about topic)
Avoid false starts/wrong information
Follow your Domain (according to company culture)
Don't be aggressive/fight
Things to Avoid
Avoid eye contact with participants
Lose confidence
Speak slowly (speak loudly)
Just speaking (Contribute valuable, non-repetitive points)
Tips and Tricks
Stop taking lead if unaware of topic
Do not hesitate to initiate if confident
Do not copy others' ideas
Act smart (listen, analyze, convert points to own words)
GD vs. Other Discussions
GD vs. Debate
GD: Aims for cluster understanding
Debate: Aims to determine credible standpoint
GD: Less formal, fewer rules
Debate: More formal, more guidelines
GD: Does not need two opposing sides
Debate: Essential to have two opposing sides
GD: Cooperation manifested
Debate: Aggression may be manifested
GD: May not have specific conclusion
Debate: Ends with a specific conclusion
Panel Discussion
Essentials of Virtual/Online GD
Before the Discussion
Be prepared online (but, uninterrupted internet)
Check surroundings (well-lit room, no external noise)
Plan a dry run (avoid technical glitch, touch with friends)
Focus on personal grooming
During the Discussion
Be on camera for the entire discussion
Be prepared to read, think, and compose answers
Follow online etiquette ("netiquette")
Avoid "flaming" (racist/inflammatory remarks)
Be open and respectful of others
Compose thoughts clearly before articulating
Interpersonal Skill
Understanding Interpersonal Skill
Abilities and behaviors for effective communication/interaction
Crucial in personal and professional contexts
Facilitates positive interactions and strong relationships
Key Abilities
Communication (verbal, non-verbal, active listening)
Teamwork (work well with others, achieve goals)
Conflict Resolution (manage disagreements constructively)
Problem-Solving (identifying issues and finding solutions)
Leadership (guide, motivate, inspire others)
Emotional Intelligence (recognize/manage own and others' emotions)
Empathy (understand and share feelings of others)
Active Listening (paying full attention, responding thoughtfully)
Adaptability (adjust to new situations/changes)
Emotional Intelligence (EQ)
Introduction to Emotional Intelligence
Testing EQ (Resource provided: globalleadershipfoundation.com)
Cross-Cultural Communication
Overview
Exchange of info and meaning between different backgrounds
Critical for success in diverse workforces
Facilitates greater understanding between teammates
Potential Divides (Differences to Bridge)
Language (dialects, accents)
Cultural norms (shaking hands vs. bowing)
Geographic location (countries, cities)
Time zone (critical for remote communication)
Age (generational values/points-of-view)
Education (PhDs vs. bachelor's degrees)
Work culture (different business cultures)
Communication style (bottom line vs. personal approach)
Impact on Business
Productivity (directly impacts collaboration)
Customer Experience (nurture positive relationships)
Marketing (must consider global audience differences)
Avoid Costly Mistakes (e.g., 'HSBC' translation error $35M)
Manifestation of Miscommunications (Examples)
Workload Misinterpretation (Lateral vs. Indirect Culture)
Slang and Colloquialisms (Frustration, slow resolution)
Job Descriptions (Unintentional bias via jargon/complexity)
Marketing Campaign Imagery (Exclusion/alienation of minority groups)
Use of Emojis (Misinterpretation, muddled message)
Steps for Improvement
Company Level Initiatives
Provide Training and Resources
Sensitivity training (onboarding, annual review)
Offer accessible cross-cultural training programs/tools
Foster channels for complaints/feedback (diversity related)
Provide writing assistants (e.g., Grammarly Business)
Establish Inclusive Policies and Standards
Include inclusivity in brand mission/values
Establish policies for working/managing across cultures
Conduct regular communication audits
Gather feedback from employees/customers
Make Communication Equitable
Account for different time zones in scheduling
Offer remote work options
Offer non-simultaneous channels (e.g., email)
Keep Messaging Consistent
Develop and share brand style guide (etiquette)
Include guidelines (written, verbal, visual)
Work with expert translators (especially global campaigns)
Individual Level Initiatives
Listen Actively and Respond with Empathy
Pay attention to nonverbal cues (esp. video calls)
Be aware of own nonverbal cues (avoid poor gestures)
Recognize different communication styles
Ensure tone matches intent
Be Respectful at All Times
Maintain a professional approach
Avoid yes/no questions (can be impolite)
Careful use of humor
Familiarize with other cultures' business etiquette
Strive for Clarity
Careful with emojis/gifs (potential misinterpretation)
Avoid jokes, colloquialisms, jargon, slang
Written content free from confusing mistakes (use AI assistant)
Footnote clearly when speaking aloud
Do not increase volume to improve understanding
Keep an Open Mind and Encourage Adaptability